CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

GARAGE DOOR TECH IN THE AI ERA

Every house has one, it breaks on the coldest morning of the year, and no robot is driving out to fix it.

★ **TL;DR — Around $75K median for hands-on repair work you can learn in 1–6 months, no license required. The catch: heavy springs, ladders, and emergency calls that do not care what day it is.** ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

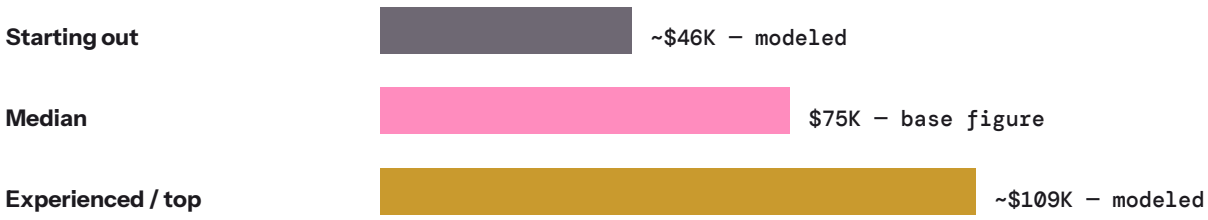
OUR TAKE: YES — WITH EYES OPEN

MEDIAN ~$75K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK LOW

- Why it works: garage doors break constantly and almost nobody DIYs a snapped torsion spring twice.
- Where it bites: the work is physical, doors are heavy, and broken springs are genuinely dangerous.
- The AI angle: AI can book the call and quote the job — it cannot show up with a ladder and fix it.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Garage Door Tech is a ~$75K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A GARAGE DOOR TECH ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Install and replace garage doors, openers, springs, cables and tracks
- ✓ Diagnose why a door groans, sticks, reverses or will not move at all
- ✓ Run service calls house to house, often same-day emergencies
- ✓ Sell the honest fix and upsell insulation, quieter openers and routine tune-ups

Think: a locksmith for the biggest moving wall in the house — part mechanic, part emergency responder.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
Scheduling, dispatch, quotes and follow-up texts are getting automated fast. Estimating apps can price a standard door from photos before a human ever visits.	The repair itself stays stubbornly physical: tensioned springs, alignment by feel, and a homeowner standing there wanting it fixed today. Judgment about what is safe to reuse is human work.

⚠ **Torsion springs under tension can seriously hurt you — this is learned hands-on with someone experienced, not from videos alone.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Different house, different problem, every few hours ✓ Mostly solo work with your own truck and tools ✓ Clear finish line: door works, customer is relieved, you leave	✗ On-call and weekend emergencies are part of the money ✗ Garages are freezing in winter and ovens in summer ✗ Heavy lifting and overhead work, every single day

Good fit? You like mechanical puzzles, driving a route, and being the person who saves someone's morning.
Bad fit? You want a desk, predictable hours, or work that never involves heights and heavy panels.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — HIRE ON AS A HELPER	DOOR B — DEALER / FRANCHISE TRAINING

Garage door companies hire helpers with no experience and train on the truck. You start carrying, cleaning and handing tools, then graduate to spring work and installs under a senior tech. Fastest route to paid skill.	Door manufacturers and franchise networks run short product and installation courses. Pair one with a helper job and you learn the systems, parts and warranty rules that make you hirable anywhere.

Smart move: Learn openers and smart controls early — the tech who can also set up the Wi-Fi opener and the app becomes the one sent on the better-paid calls.
Where you land after: Senior tech, installer lead, or your own one-truck door company taking the overflow the big shops cannot schedule.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
LEARN THE	GET HIRED	MASTER SPRING	RUN YOUR	ADD INSTALLS	DECIDE YOUR

STEP 1 — Learn the anatomy

FREE · WEEK 1

- Study door types, springs, openers and tracks until you can name every part
- Watch full installs and repairs, not highlight clips — note the safety steps

STEP 2 — Get hired as a helper

PAID · WEEKS 2-6

- Apply to local door companies and franchises — most train from zero
- Bring a clean driving record; you will be driving their truck

STEP 3 — Master spring safety

ON THE JOB · MONTHS 1-3

- Learn winding, tensioning and cable work only with an experienced tech present
- Build the habit: treat every loaded spring like it wants to hurt you

STEP 4 — Run your own calls

PAID · MONTHS 2-4

- Take standard service calls solo: sensors, remotes, rollers, tune-ups
- Practice explaining the fix and the price before you start work

STEP 5 — Add installs and openers

PAID · MONTHS 3-6

- Move up to full door installs and smart opener setups
- Learn insulation upgrades and quiet-drive systems — the margin lives there

STEP 6 — Decide your lane MONTH 6

- Stay and climb: senior tech and install lead pay more per hour
- Or start pricing your own side jobs toward a solo truck

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- Today: learn the parts of a garage door system and find three local door companies.
- Days 1–30: apply for helper roles; ride along and absorb installs if hired.
- Days 31–60: practice spring and cable work under supervision only.
- Days 61–90: run simple service calls with a senior tech checking your work.
- Day 90: you are employable help anywhere doors break — keep stacking install reps.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest "probably NOT you". → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ **DOORS BREAK. SOMEBODY LOCAL FIXES THEM.** ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.